

Riverside Borough Council

Council Tax Information Guide

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Department:	Revenue & Benefits
Contact:	counciltax@riverside.gov.uk
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1. Council Tax Overview

What is Council Tax?

Council tax is a local taxation system used to fund local services in Riverside Borough. It is charged on domestic properties and collected by Riverside Borough Council on behalf of local authorities.

Who Pays Council Tax?

- Property owners (if occupied by the owner)
- Tenants (if renting)
- Residents aged 18 and over
- Joint occupiers share responsibility

Council Tax Bands (2024/2025)

Council tax bands are determined by the Valuation Office Agency (VOA) based on the estimated market value of your property as of **1 April 1991**. Even though property values have changed significantly since then, the 1991 valuation date is still used as the basis for banding.

Band	Property Value Range (1991 Valuation)	Annual Charge (2024/2025)
A	Up to £40,000	£1,234.56
B	£40,001 - £52,000	£1,440.32

C	£52,001 - £68,000	£1,646.08
D	£68,001 - £88,000	£1,851.84
E	£88,001 - £120,000	£2,263.36
F	£120,001 - £160,000	£2,674.88
G	£160,001 - £320,000	£3,086.40
H	Over £320,000	£3,703.68

Important Notes:

- The property value ranges are based on what your property would have been worth on 1 April 1991
- Your band stays the same even if property values have increased since 1991
- The annual charges shown are for the 2024/2025 financial year and may change each year
- New properties are assigned a band based on what they would have been worth in 1991

2. Discounts and Exemptions

Single Person Discount (25%)

If you are the only adult (18+) living in the property, you qualify for a 25% discount.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Must be the sole adult resident
- Students, apprentices, and certain carers don't count as adults
- Application required with proof of single occupancy

How to Apply:

1. Complete form SPD-01 (available online or by post)
2. Provide proof of single occupancy (utility bills, tenancy agreement)
3. Processing time: 10-15 working days
4. Discount applied from the date of application

Empty Property Discounts

Unfurnished and Unoccupied:

- First 3 months: 100% discount
- Months 4-6: 50% discount
- After 6 months: Full charge applies

Furnished but Unoccupied (Second Homes):

- No discount available
- Full council tax charge applies
- Premium charge of 100% may apply after 2 years

Student Exemptions

Full-time students are exempt from council tax.

Qualifying Criteria:

- Enrolled on a course lasting at least 1 academic year
- Studying at least 21 hours per week
- Course must be at a recognized institution

Required Documentation:

- Student certificate from university/college
- Valid for current academic year only
- Must be renewed annually

3. Payment Methods and Plans

Direct Debit (Recommended)

- Automatic payments - never miss a payment
- Spread payments over 10 or 12 months
- Protected by Direct Debit Guarantee
- Easy to set up online or by phone

Other Payment Methods

- Online banking or telephone banking
- Debit/credit card (online or by phone)
- Standing order
- PayPoint (at local shops)
- Post Office
- Cheque by post

Payment Plans

Standard Plan (10 monthly payments):

Payments due on the 1st of each month from April to January

Extended Plan (12 monthly payments):

Payments due on the 1st of each month from April to March

Lower monthly amount but no payment-free months

4. Council Tax Support

Council Tax Support (previously Council Tax Benefit) helps people on low incomes pay their council tax. You could get up to 100% of your council tax paid depending on your circumstances.

Who Can Apply?

- People on low income or benefits
- Pensioners
- People with disabilities
- Carers
- Families with children

How Much Support Can I Get?

The amount of support depends on:

- Your income and savings
- Your household composition
- Your council tax band
- Whether you receive other benefits

5. Contact Information

Riverside Borough Council - Revenue & Benefits Department

Address:

Riverside Borough Council
Council Tax Department
Civic Centre
Riverside
RS1 2AB

Phone: 0800 123 4567

Email: counciltax@riverside.gov.uk

Website: www.riverside.gov.uk/counciltax

Opening Hours:

Monday - Friday: 9:00 AM - 5:00 PM

Saturday: 9:00 AM - 12:00 PM

Sunday: Closed

Emergency Contact (out of hours): 0800 123 9999